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2025 MALAWI SCHOOL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION MOCK II EXAMINATION.

AGRICULTURE

Subject Number: MO12/II

Tuesday, 26th May, 2025

Time Allowed: 1½ hour sessions

08:00 am onwards.

PAPER II

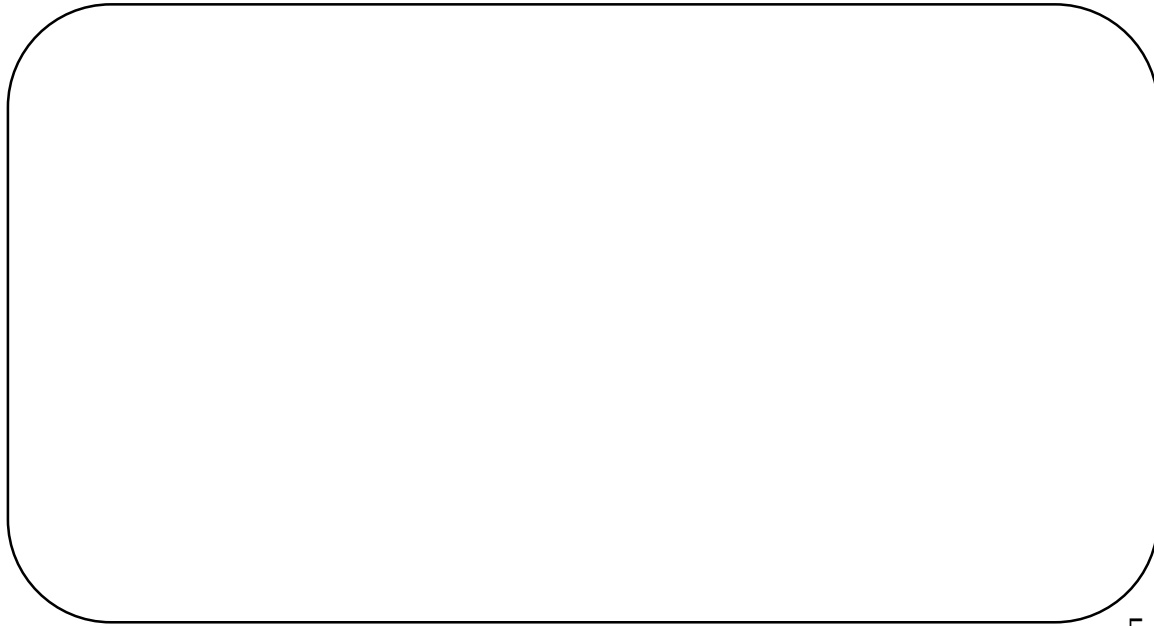
(40 marks)

Practical**Instructions**

1. This paper contains 6 printed pages. Please check.
2. The paper contains two sections **A** and **B**. Section **A** contains two descriptive questions and section **B** has two practical questions.
3. Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
4. Fill in your name and examination number at the top of each page of the question paper.
5. In the table provided on this page, tick against the question you have answered.

Questions Answered	Tick if Answered	Do not write in this column
1		
2		
3		
4		
Total		

Expected results



5 marks

2. A farmer was provided with four in-breds of maize with the following characteristics.

- Inbred **W** : early maturing
- Inbred **X** : high resistance against maize streak virus
- Inbred **Y** : short height that resists plant lodging
- Inbred **Z** : high yielding per unit area

a. With the aid of well labelled crosses, illustrate how the farmer would develop a new variety that would retain all the characteristics from the four in-breds.

6 marks

- b.** What method of crop improvement has been used in question 2(a).

_____ 1 mark

- c.** State the importance of emasculation during crop improvement.

_____ 1 mark

- d.** Briefly describe the importance of achieving uniformity as one of the objectives in crop improvement.

_____ 2 marks

Section B: 20 marks.

Answer all questions using the specimens provided. Follow instructions for each question carefully.

- 3.** You are provided with the following specimens labelled **M**, **N**, **O** use the specimens to answer the questions that follow.

- a.** Identify the agricultural chemical labelled **N**.

_____ 1 mark

- b.** List any two physical properties of soil sample **M**.

_____ 2 marks

- c.** Briefly describe one way in which each of the following characteristics of parent material affect pH of soil sample **M**.

- i.** Physical nature of the parent material.

_____ 2 marks

- ii.** Chemical nature of the parent material.

_____ 2 marks

- d.** Mix specimen **N** with **M**. State any two importance of the activity performed on the productivity of soil **M**.

2 marks

- e.** State any one functional similarity between specimen **N** and **O** in agriculture.

1 mark

- 4.** You are provided with two specimens **C** and **D**. Use the specimens to answer the following questions.

- a.** Name any two products that can be obtained from processing specimen **D**.

2 marks

- b.** Explain any two ways in which processing of specimen **D** is important.

4 marks

- c.** The demand for specimen **C** is said to be inelastic in Malawi.

- i.** Why is the demand for specimen labelled **C** inelastic? Give one reason.

1 mark

- ii.** Sketch a graph to illustrate the type of elasticity of demand for specimen **C**.

3 marks